

NITISH KUMAR PANDA

Thane, Maharashtra, India

☎ +91-8658278293 ✉ kumarpandanitish038@gmail.com [in linkedin.com/in/nitish-panda](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nitish-panda) [github nitishkumar-ld.github.io/Portfolio/](https://github.com/nitishkumar-ld) 🌐

Professional Summary

Level Designer & Environment Specialist with expertise in **Unreal Engine 5**. Specialized in creating immersive gameplay spaces with a focus on player flow, spatial storytelling, and technical optimization (Nanite, LODs, Lumen). Experienced in delivering high-quality stealth and co-op designs within professional studio pipelines.

Technical Skills

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (Specialist), Unity
Level Design: Greyboxing/Whiteboxing, Combat Pacing, Player Flow, Spatial Puzzles, Navigation
Tech Art Pipeline: Optimization (Nanite, LODs), Lighting (Lumen, Volumetrics), Niagara VFX Basics
Game Design: GDD Documentation, Economy Loops, System Design, Progression Systems

Experience

Akiyam (Gujarat) Nov. 2024 – Present

Level Designer (Assassin: The First List - Steam Release) Remote

- Designed and polished **4 full stealth levels** from blackout to high-fidelity final environments.
- Developed non-linear level architecture with strategic verticality for multiple gameplay approaches.
- Designed AI guard patrol routes and encounter positioning to maximize player tension and engagement.
- Utilized composition and lighting to ensure objective readability in professional, dense environments.

Underdogs Studio (Mumbai) Nov. 2024 – Present

Level Designer (Confidential Co-op Project) Remote

- Developed synchronized co-op puzzles requiring dual-player spatial coordination and communication.
- Managed split-path navigation to ensure balanced engagement for both players in professional loops.
- Collaborated with studio lead designers to align environmental flow with core project objectives.

Projects

3D Hustle | *Unreal Engine, Itch.io* Jan. 2025

- Lead Designer: Authored the complete **Game Design Document (GDD)** and core economy loops.
- Engineered progression systems and spatial navigation mechanics for a high-readability platformer.
- Optimized collision and platforming geometry to maintain player momentum and flow.

Psych Horror Prototype | *Unreal Engine, Lumen* Dec. 2024

- Designed an atmospheric horror level utilizing negative space and high-contrast volumetric lighting.
- Controlled emotional pacing through claustrophobic spatial design and shadow-driven storytelling.

The Dyeing World | *Unreal Engine, 3D Platformer* Oct. 2024

- Used color-coded environment shapes to naturally guide player movement through exploration zones.

Santas Revenge (Game Jam) | *Unity, Arena Combat* Dec. 2024

- Designed a linear combat arena and enemy encounter pacing under a strict **48-hour deadline**.

Education

KIIT University 2019

Master's Degree Bhubaneswar, India

Gamer2Maker 2024

Game Design Certification Online